



- **Nettuts+ Fetch:** If you routinely need to work with remote files, this is a handy package. Just configure your popular remote files, and this package will fetch the latest version for you whenever you want.
- **ColorPicker:** This allows you to tweak CSS colours with a handy colour picker.
- **SublimeREPL:** This gives Sublime Text an inbuilt REPL or Read Evaluate Print Loop or in other words interpreter. It supports a number of languages, from Python and JavaScript to F# and R.
- **Gist:** If you use GitHub, the Gist plug-in will come handy as it allows you to quickly publish some code from a local file to a Gist.

Once you have the package manager installed, just search for these packages using that and install them if you want. There are nearly a thousand packages available for Sublime Text that do everything from adding support for specific frameworks, adding support for VCS systems, changing the theme or colour scheme, automatic linting, adding support for more languages, and lot more.



Edit at multiple points

Another powerful feature of Sublime Text is multiple cursors. With multiple cursors active, you can type the same text in multiple locations at the same time.

To use multiple cursors, simply click in multiple places in your document while keeping the Ctrl key pressed. Wherever you click, a new cursor will be added, and any text you type now will simultaneously appear in all those places.

A keyboard shortcut for this is also available, press Ctrl+Alt+Up or Ctrl+Alt+Down to add another

cursor at the same column in the line above, or below respectively. To get rid of multiple cursors, and switch back to a single one—as you would obviously want to do at some point, just press Esc.



Multiple Selections

Just like you can have multiple cursors, you can have multiple selection as well, which let you modify multiple places at the same time.

The process of making multiple selections is simple. If you have some text selected, and you would like to select more text elsewhere, just drag and select that text while keeping Ctrl pressed.

This feature is a lot more powerful though. Let's say you realise after writing a lot of text that you spelled 'colour' as 'color' and you were supposed to use the British spelling? Simply put your cursor over 'color' and press Ctrl+D; this will select 'color' and highlight other instances. Now keep pressing Ctrl+D till all — or as many as you want — instances are selected. Then simply type in the replacement.



Modifying settings

You may find that Sublime Text doesn't really have a settings panel like you might expect. There is no GUI for configuring the software, but what you do have is a rich set of configuration files that let you alter nearly everything about the software.

In the Preferences menu, you will find entries such as Settings - Default and Settings - User. Altering either of them will change the desired setting, but only the User settings will survive an update to a plug-in or of Sublime Text.

By default many "User" setting will be blank, but you can open the "Default" versions of

the config files to see what settings are available to configure. If you want you can just copy-paste the contents of the default file in the user file and only modify the settings you want. This is recommended because this file has to be in a very specific format called JSON.

The settings are terse variable names, but the names are often self-explanatory. For example: "spell_check" sets whether Sublime Text automatically highlights spelling mistakes by default, you might want to enable it if you mostly work with non-code text; "highlight_line" sets whether the line(s) containing a cursor should be highlighted. Most plug-ins will

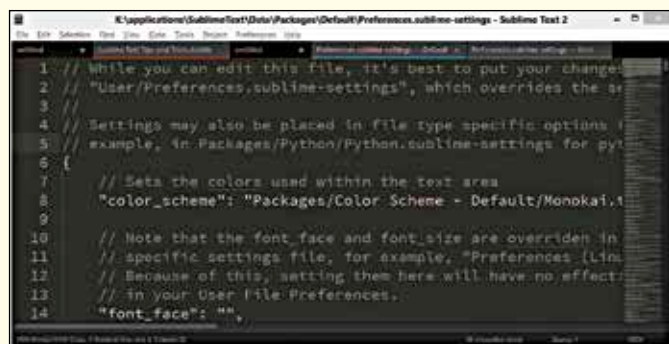
that, we'll assume that is what you have done.

Find the line that says "theme", which by default is set to "Default.sublime-theme". Change this setting based on the theme you installed. Try it with the popular "Soda" theme. Install the Soda theme using the package manager, and then change this setting to "Soda Light.sublime-theme" for the light version of the theme, or "Soda Dark.sublime-theme" for the dark version.



Colour Scheme

Like the theme, the syntax highlighting scheme used by Sublime Text can also be changed. Like themes, you can



Here we see the Nexus theme using the Nexus code highlighting

have their own setting, which too will be divided into default and user.



Change the theme

The default UI theme is pretty good, but you may have your own preferences, and luckily for you the theme can be changed. Installing a theme is simple thanks to the package manager, just search for "theme". Switching themes however, requires you to edit the configuration files.

Select Settings - User from the Preferences menu. As we said before, this file uses the JSON format, if you don't know what that is just copy the everything from Settings - Default and make changes to

find colour schemes using the package manager. Just search for scheme and you should see many of them.

Sublime Text has a simple UI for changing colour schemes; they are all listed hierarchically under Preferences > Color Scheme. Some themes also include colour schemes that fit with that scheme.



Make a plug-in

If all else fails you can always make your own plug-in for Sublime Text. You will notice that the Tools menu has a New Plugin... option. Sublime Text plug-ins are written in Python, so you will need to know that a bit in order to do something useful. You can check out a tutorial here: <http://dgit.in/149A1bt>.